Question:
Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's?
Answer Choices:
A. Being African or Hispanic American
B. A lower level of education
C. Living in a city
D. Being married
E. Having a family history of Alzheimer's
F. High intake of saturated fats
G. Older age
H. Eating fish
I. Being a smoker
J. Drinking alcohol regularly

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
AlzheimerâĢĻs disease risk is influenced by a complex interplay of genetic, demographic, and behavioral factors. Population-level epidemiology shows that individuals who are African or Hispanic American tend to have higher rates of AlzheimerâĢĻs compared with European American counterparts. This reflects greater exposure to shared environmental exposures (e.g., pollutants, social inequalities) and, in some cases, genetic risk factors, rather than a protective association with aging or marital status.

Educational attainment also strongly protects against AlzheimerâĢĻs: higher literacy and cognitive reserve tend to buffer risk, and lower education is associated with greater risk.

MarriageâĢĻs association with AlzheimerâĢĻs is not well established; while some studies associate marital status with outcomes, the strongest and most consistent factor is age.

Family history of AlzheimerâĢĻs adds substantial risk, not protective effects.

A diet high in saturated fat increases AlzheimerâĢĻs risk, as does smoking and drinking alcohol regularly, both of which worsen vascular risk factors and accelerate cognitive decline. Saturated fat intake is associated with increased oxidative stress and inflammation, contributing to neuropathological changes, whereas alcohol use (particularly excessive) is neurotoxic and accelerates brain atrophy.

Living in a city and eating fish, while healthy and beneficial in many contexts, do not counteract established AlzheimerâĢĻs risk factors. City-dwelling is associated with stress and social exposure (which can be detrimental to cognitive health), and high fish intake (especially long-chain omega-3 fatty acids) has mixed evidence and does not negate the strong, established risk associations with higher saturated fat and lower education; fish itself does not confer protection against the disease.

Therefore, among the options, only older age is associated with increased risk.

Correct answer: G. Older age
</think>
<answer>
G. Older age
</answer>